Department of
EDUCATIONAL PSYCHOLOGY

Application guide:
Counseling and student personnel psychology MA

Use this guide as a checklist to help you complete your application. **All applications must be submitted by January 8, 2018.**

Requirements for all applicants

Materials	How to submit
Application	**Required fields:** • Program Selection • Term Selection • Biographical Information • Personal Background • Academic History (including transcripts) • Test Scores • Employment • Materials (including: Personal Statement, Resume/CV) **Optional fields:** Diversity Statements are optional but highly encouraged. All other fields or application materials are optional but will be taken into consideration if submitted. Access the online application.
Application Fee	Visit the Graduate School's website for more information.
Transcripts (Academic History)	**Upload your unofficial transcript to the graduate application under "Academic History."** If you are admitted, you will need to provide an official transcript (sent to us by mail from the institution). An

	official, certified (signature and seal) with English Translations should be attached if the transcripts are not in English.
Graduate Record Examination (GRE) scores	**CSPP applicants should take the GRE General Test. You do not need to take any subject tests.** **Average GRE (after 2011):** Verbal: 155; Quantitative: 156; Written: 4 1. Self report your GRE scores by entering them into the "Test Scores" section in the graduate application. 2. Send your official GRE score to the Graduate School; use institution code 6874.
English Language Test Scores (TOEFL, IELTS, etc.)	Report your TOEFL, IELTS, or MELAB scores (non-native English speakers only) in the "Test Scores" section. Minimum TOEFL (non-native English speakers only) • Minimum overall score: 79 • Writing: 21 • Reading: 19 • Paper-based TOEFL: 550 • IELTS: 6.5 • MELAB: 80 Visit the Graduate School's website for more information.
Letters of Recommendation	**Three letters of recommendation**—from professors or others who are able to comment on your educational and professional goals and potential—are required. You must input the names and contact information for each recommendation provider in the graduate application. They will be sent directions on how to upload their letter directly into your application.

Materials

Required Materials

Personal Statement	This statement is the most essential part of your application. It should outline your interests and professional goals and answer all of the following questions (in an essay format): • How did you become interested in this profession? • Discuss your motives for pursuing this profession. • What do you consider to be your strengths (specific skills, talents, aptitudes)? • What do you consider to be your weaknesses? • What aspects of or specific issues in counseling interest you most? • What kinds of work do you see yourself doing five years after you get your degree? Which track would you like to pursue (school counseling, mental health counseling, or higher education counseling?) Please describe briefly any participation in research, counseling activities, or employment which might be relevant to your application. • What specific factors have led you to apply to Minnesota for this specialization? • Discuss your expectations of this graduate program Upload the essay under “Personal Statement" in the Materials section in the graduate application.
Resume/Curriculum Vitae (CV)	Upload it under “Resume/CV” in the Materials section of the graduate application. Include your past professional, academic, and volunteer experiences as they relate to your work in the fields of psychology, counseling, education, and research.

Graduate Program Additional Materials	
Program Application	**Only required if you've taken a course for graduate credit** (See form for details.) 1. Complete the Graduate Program Form Additional Application. 2. Upload it under "Graduate Program Additional Upload" in the graduate application.

Optional application materials

Materials	How to submit
Diversity Statement	Submitting the diversity statement is optional, but is highly encouraged. This statement may be used to nominate exceptional applicants for graduate fellowships. Describe how your background, experiences, and achievements will contribute to the program and the University's goals of promoting excellence through diversity. If applicable, you may mention hardships or obstacles you overcame to complete your previous undergraduate or graduate education (e.g., coming from a low-income background or being a first-generation college student). **Tip:** Tell *your* story. If you learned from obstacles you personally overcame, write about them. If you grew up with privilege, write about how you discovered your privilege. It might be tempting to write about someone else's experience, an entire group's experience, or diversity and inclusion in an abstract way. But most often, admissions teams want to understand how you personally came to be

	empathetic, reflective, resilient, and aware of systematic inequalities. Upload the message under “Diversity Statement” in the Materials section of the graduation application.
Writing Samples	Upload publications and articles in the graduate application under “Writing Samples.”
Extenuating Circumstances	You may upload a brief statement explaining any extenuating circumstances that may have affected your grades or test scores.
Common Ground Consortium	If you wish to be considered for a Common Ground Consortium fellowship for African American students, please be sure to indicate this on your program application, and then upload a statement briefly addressing the following question: Given that the University of Minnesota is a public grant institution, it is imperative that CGC scholars can both benefits personally from their membership in the program as well as further the university’s founding mission to contribute to scholarship that benefits the local and greater communities. Please describe how your participation as a CGC scholar would do the following: • Enhance your graduate student experience • Prepare you for your chosen career • Benefit the public

Visit: z.umn.edu/cspp-apply/

Contact: cspp@umn.edu or 612-624-6083

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